

Empowering women in rural Sri Lanka: the success story of S.M.S.

Manasifa

introduction



Nestled amidst the arid landscapes of Rotawewa, Trincomalee, where the scorching sun beats down relentlessly, Akram Farmshop stands as a beacon of hope and prosperity. At its helm is S.M.S. Mnasifa, a woman whose journey from humble beginnings to entrepreneurial success is a testament to the transformative power of opportunity, perseverance, and community support.

Siezing opportunity

For Mnasifa, life changed irrevocably when she became a beneficiary of the JSB project, an initiative spearheaded by the Japanese government with technical assistance from UNDP and social mobilization efforts by Janathakshan Gte Ltd. The project aimed to uplift rural communities by empowering women like Mnasifa through poultry farming—a venture that promised economic independence and self-sustainability.

From humble beginnings to prosperity

Equipped with two mini hatcheries boasting a capacity of 176 eggs each and 50 parent stock of chickens, Mnasifa embarked on her entrepreneurial journey with hope and determination. Before the project, her family's income was a modest 15,000 rupees, barely sufficient to meet their needs. However, with the support and resources provided by the project, Mnasifa witnessed a remarkable transformation in their fortunes. Today, her earnings have soared to 45,000 rupees from chick hatching alone, supplemented by an additional 10,000 rupees from selling eggs—a significant improvement that has brought newfound stability and prosperity to her household.

Nurturing growth and sustainability

With unwavering dedication, Mnasifa meticulously tended to her poultry farm, utilizing the resources provided by the project to their fullest potential. Setting up a parents coop and brooding coop ensured the optimal health and well-being of her chickens, thereby maximizing productivity. Additionally, with the guidance of the project, Mnasifa established an azolla pond—a sustainable source of feed for her livestock, further enhancing the efficiency and sustainability of her farm.

Family support and community impact.

Central to Mnasifa's success story is the unwavering support of her family, including her husband and daughter. Together, they not only contribute to the day-to-day operations of the farm but also derive nutritional benefits from the eggs produced—a testament to the holistic advantages of their enterprise. Moreover, Mnasifa's success has reverberated throughout her community, inspiring other women to pursue entrepreneurship and break free from the constraints of poverty and traditional gender roles.

Looking toward the future

As Mnasifa gazes towards the horizon, her dreams extend far beyond the confines of her own farm. With a steadfast determination to expand her business, she envisions hiring additional labor and scaling up her sales through the project-funded outlet—a move that promises to further augment her income and impact. Furthermore, Mnasifa remains committed to supporting other beneficiaries in their journey towards self-sufficiency, thereby advancing the overarching objectives of the project and fostering sustainable development in her community.

Conclusion

S.M.S. Mnasifa's success story stands as a shining example of the transformative power of opportunity, perseverance, and community support. Through the JSB project, backed by the Japanese government, and with the invaluable assistance of UNDP and Janathakshan Gte Ltd, she has not only transformed her own life but also become a catalyst for change and progress within her community. As she continues to inspire and empower others, Mnasifa embodies the indomitable spirit of resilience and entrepreneurship, proving that with determination and support, even the most arid landscapes can give rise to fields of prosperity and hope.